AWS announced an alternative to Amazon SQS in November 2017: Amazon MQ provides Apache ActiveMQ as a service. Therefore, you can use Amazon MQ as a message broker that speaks the JMS, NMS, AMQP, STOMP, MQTT, and WebSocket protocols.

Go to the Amazon MQ Developer Guide at http://mng.bz/AVP7 to learn more.

Summary

- Decoupling makes things easier because it reduces dependencies.
- Synchronous decoupling requires two sides to be available at the same time, but the sides don’t have to know each other.
- With asynchronous decoupling, you can communicate without both sides being available.
- Most applications can be synchronously decoupled without touching the code, by using a load balancer offered by the ELB service.
- A load balancer can make periodic health checks to your application to determine whether the backend is ready to serve traffic.
- Asynchronous decoupling is possible only with asynchronous processes, but you can modify a synchronous process to be an asynchronous one most of the time.
- Asynchronous decoupling with SQS requires programming against SQS with one of the SDKs.